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Contested probate

Additional fixed fees for specifically defined proceedings. Attorney screening and a written scope are required before engagement.

\$5,000 base fee + specifically approved litigation fees. The base covers opening, ordinary administration and closing. Litigation fees below are added to the base, with no offset. Each additional scope requires your specific written acceptance before a charge.

Defined service / event	Fixed fee
Standard will contest Standard litigation package	\$50,000
Standard asset recovery / title citation Standard litigation package	\$20,000
Contested creditor claim Defined claim proceeding	\$10,000
Contested heirship Defined heirship proceeding	\$15,000
Fiduciary removal / surcharge Defined removal or surcharge proceeding	\$25,000
Contested accounting Defined accounting dispute	\$12,500
Will / trust construction Defined construction proceeding	\$12,500

No duplicate charges. Ordinary subpoenas, discovery, motions, mediation and trial within a retained litigation package are included. No stacked charges, extra trial-day fees or hourly conversion. A listed event is not automatically a new charge.

Example: \$5,000 base + \$50,000 standard will contest = \$55,000. Motions within that proceeding are included. Complex matters receive one higher fixed quote upfront. Appeals, trust-validity contests and separate enforcement require an individually quoted fixed fee; see page 3.

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Contested guardianship

Additional fees for separately defined contested or extraordinary proceedings. A later dispute does not create an automatic charge.

\$5,000 base fee + specifically approved litigation fees. The base covers opening, ordinary administration and closing. Litigation fees below are added to the base, with no offset. Each additional scope requires your specific written acceptance before a charge.

Defined service / event	Fixed fee
Contested guardianship Standard contested litigation package	\$25,000
Contested guardianship modification, restoration or termination A separate contested proceeding; not routine closing or termination.	\$12,500
Extraordinary guardianship petition Only where outside the retained scope; not an ordinary uncontested add-on.	\$3,500
Emergency guardianship / asset preservation Only a separately retained emergency proceeding or asset-preservation scope.	\$5,000
Fiduciary removal / surcharge Only a distinct scope not already within a retained package.	\$25,000
Contested accounting Only a distinct dispute not already within a retained package.	\$12,500

No duplicate charges. Ordinary subpoenas, discovery, motions, mediation and trial within a retained litigation package are included. No stacked charges, extra trial-day fees or hourly conversion. A listed event is not automatically a new charge.

Example: \$5,000 base + \$25,000 standard contested guardianship = \$30,000. Motions within that proceeding are included. Ordinary uncontested guardianship is addressed on page 4.

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Additional defined services

These are alternatives or separately retained scopes—not automatic line items added to a litigation package.

Defined service / event	Fixed fee
Subpoena	\$750 per recipient
Discovery citation	\$3,500 per respondent
Nonroutine unopposed motion	\$1,250
Contested non-evidentiary motion	\$3,500
Motion to dismiss: preparation, response, briefing and argument	\$3,500
Formal proof Probate procedure	\$5,500
Uncontested admission of a copy will Probate procedure; does not change the guardianship annual-only rule.	\$6,500
Supervised-administration supplement through closing Probate supervision through closing; disclose upfront when known.	\$3,500
Standalone mediation Standalone service, not mediation already included in a package.	\$3,500
Trust validity contest, appeal or separate enforcement	Quoted fixed fee

No duplicate charges. Ordinary subpoenas, discovery, motions, mediation and trial within a retained litigation package are included. No stacked charges, extra trial-day fees or hourly conversion. A listed event is not automatically a new charge.

A later change to supervised administration requires a separately approved addendum. Included motions, appearances and approvals are not billed again.

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Uncontested guardianship

Opening, ordinary administration and closing are included in the retained scope. Annual reporting is the only additional firm-fee category for ordinary uncontested guardianship.

Annual Report on the Ward

\$750

per year it is prepared and filed

Preparation and filing of the personal report, separate from the initial guardianship fee.

For ordinary uncontested guardianship, annual reporting is the only additional firm fee. Routine administration, closing and termination within the retained scope are included. The Annual Report on the Ward costs \$750 per year for preparation and filing. A later contested proceeding requires its own specifically accepted fixed-fee addendum.

Your scope and fee protections

- Every additional service needs a stated scope, exact fixed fee and your specific acceptance of an addendum before a charge. A general acknowledgment does not authorize future charges.
- Required court approval remains separate; this guide does not authorize payment from estate or ward funds.
- Settlement completes the defined retained work. If representation ends before that work is complete, any refund reflects work performed, subject to mandatory reasonableness, refund and court-review requirements.
- Existing signed agreements and previously included expenses remain protected. This prospective guide does not impose retroactive charges.